

Self Evaluation Report

Agreed



Drake Primary School

URN: 120995

School Context

BRIEF SUMMARY

Drake Primary (**NOR 420**) was an infant school for 37 years, has now grown to a primary phase maintained school with an Autism Specialist Resource Base.

September 2019 we welcomed our first Year 6 class. A new leadership team and headteacher. September 2020 the leadership team grew with the addition of a new Assistant Head Teacher. September 2022 the leadership team consisted of the Head Teacher and the two Deputy Heads, (promotion of the Assistant Heads) along with the SENDCO. In January 2023, Drake Primary entered into a partnership with another school in order to support their improvement. This involved a further restructure of the leadership team.

September 2023, new members joined the leadership team following a very successful recruitment process. **The new and current leadership team consists of Executive Head Teacher, Head of School, Deputy Head, SENDCO, and two Assistant Head Teachers. The SRB Lead also has a significant role in school.**

Age range: 4 - 11 (with onsite nursery non LA)

Total pupils: 420

SRB pupils: 13 - growing to 16.

Pupil Premium: 73 - 17.4%

SEND total: 66 - 15.7%

SEND EHCP: 27 - 6.4%

EAL: 112 - 26.7%

LAC:3 - 0.71% (Post LAC 8 - 1.9%)

Forces: 17 - 4.1%

Young Carers: 7 - 1.7% (a further 24 children have been identified as young carers but parents have not engaged - total school young carers 31 - 7.4%)

Attendance is 96.46%, which is above National (93.9%)

Persistent absence 7.1%. Attendance is monitored closely by the pastoral team and Parent Support Advisor who works directly with families. Some current families with persistent absence are due to family circumstances and/or medical/SEND needs.

Data correct on 8/11/2023

Indices of deprivation show the school serves a community of families who are in the lowest 10% for Education, skills and training and in the lowest 40% across the Multiple Indices of Deprivation. Our community is made up from a wide range of families from different cultures and faith back grounds. A large group of Polish, Russian and Lithuanian pupils as well as Portuguese families attend our school and use the day care. We have in the last year received three child refugees from Ukraine.

Drake Primary was inspected by OFSTED in November 2021 and was graded Good in all areas.

In recent years, Drake Primary has seen significant capital programmes for the build of our new SRB for ASD and re-assigning the use of the existing classrooms and spaces and the infra-structure to enhance the learning opportunities for all children. Whilst reaching its conclusion in 2022/23, this has been a significant project and has caused some limitations, particularly in regards to space and capacity around school and for the Reception classes who moved to a new building mid year.

In addition to this challenge, leaders still endeavoured to address concerns and priorities identified in 2018/19 and have also been navigating the opening of schools post-pandemic and ensuring that a recovery curriculum focussed on identifying gaps in skills and knowledge and prioritising those most necessary for progression and transition. Whilst understanding the priorities

regarding core subjects, we also recognised the significant loss of experiences and opportunities during this time and felt it essential to prioritise the social and emotional wellbeing of children. We continued to develop our curriculum to offer a wide range of opportunities and experiences for children including trips and visitors, art and music. Subject leaders used time allocated to develop progression maps and planning formats and used national frameworks to structure school improvement. As a result we have been awarded

Quality Mark for English and Maths

Platinum Artsmark – the only primary school in Norfolk to receive this at the time it was awarded.

Primary Science Quality mark

Games Marks Silver

Eco-Schools

Forest Schools

We are currently working towards the Autism Accreditation and have registered for the Artsmark renewal in 2 years time.

Quality of Education

JUDGEMENT



Leaders, including governors are committed to ensuring that all pupils, particularly disadvantaged pupils and including pupils with SEND, make good progress. The school's Mission Vision and Aims, has been critical in the curriculum design and our ambitions for the children. In all aspects of school life, children's wellbeing and strong education built on a wide variety of experiences to ensure breadth and depth is evident in order to create the foundations for their futures.

Over the course of study, teaching is designed to help pupils to remember long term the content they have been taught and to integrate new knowledge into larger ideas. Our curriculum design includes themes rather than topics as this broader approach to curriculum ensures that children are encouraged to make better links between their curriculum subjects and also their own experiences and lives. Pupils' aspirations are a high priority at Drake as an area of disadvantage and a history of low aspiration. Our curriculum aims to inspire and to help children discover their interests and passions so that they consider themselves lifelong learners. Developing life skills and equipping children to navigate their world including digital and online platforms supports our ambitions for our curriculum over the coming years. We introduce a range of inspirational people to the children and explore our school values reflected in all aspects of life. Our class names reflect this well along with other inspirational and significant people (past and present) within our curriculum. Our inclusive ethos ensures that inspirational people include representations of our school community, including those with SEND. When naming an SRB class after Jason Arday, he came to visit, meeting the children and delivering an inspiration speech to parents of children with SEND or having a place in the SRB.

Subject related planning, devised by leaders with specialists has resulted in a move away from bought in schemes in most areas. This enables pupils to learn their theme in a relevant context they have the opportunities to see the connections between aspects of their learning in relation to the context of the school and our pupils and the wider world. With wide reaching concepts and thought provoking key questions, our curriculum is accessible for all pupils including those with SEND. The majority of children who attend the SRB access their mainstream classes well and have individual timetables and support. Strategies are explicitly taught to support them to regulate and navigate the social and academic aspects of school life. These strategies, such as the zones of regulation are shared across school for us in all classrooms with all children. Other SEND strategies are also supported by the specialist team. Our subject leaders provide materials and resources to support CPD and subject knowledge and investigate frameworks which promote best practice. For example, we have been accredited Platinum Artsmark, Silver Games Mark, English and Maths Quality Mark, Primary Science Quality Mark. Teachers and support staff understand how these frameworks can be used to ensure that the school remains innovative, supported by current research and best practice and always striving for the best outcomes for children.

The Curriculum development is well underway, the whole school community are ambitious about what we can still achieve to further close the disadvantage gaps in our community.

SLT have undertaken book looks, lesson observations and Assistant Heads review medium term planning and sequences of learning. Subject leaders are beginning to review planning more effectively and monitor progress across school according to their 100 day subject action plans. SLT review teacher performance together and understand strengths and weaknesses of teaching across school. SLT undertake performance management meetings to ensure that teachers are set targets in line with their career development and their current teaching practice. As a result teachers receive feedback regarding their practice frequently so that a drop in performance does not have long term effects on the quality of education.

Balancing the high expectations for all areas of the curriculum is sometimes challenging but staff are committed to this outcome for children and understand the importance of a broad and balanced curriculum enriched with a wide range of opportunities, particularly for the demographics of Drake Primary. Subject leaders are being given time to track progression across year groups and regular monitoring is helping teachers ensure quality of planning and teaching. The use of planning sequences has evolved over the past three years and is now better supporting teaching across subjects. Refining this remains a focus for SLT and subject leads. Coverage and breadth of the curriculum is evidenced on the school website and is reviewed in conjunction with other monitoring. Using a continuous provision approach in year 1 allows the children to practice and

apply their learning and skills, capturing this learning in books develops across the year. Practical evidence on the school website, and looking at progression between pieces of work, particularly in writing demonstrates the impact of teaching.

Drake has an ambition for all children to be able to read and for end of year results to exceed National averages. A recent change to the assessment of core subjects aims to ensure that children are able to apply their understanding in a full range of contexts. Assessment of other subjects is supported by subject leads. The school uses Pupil Asset to track all pupils from EYFS, KS1, KS2 and yearly starting points and to provide data reports analysing the attainment and progress of children including vulnerable groups. Termly summative assessments in English, Maths and Science are used to and provide opportunities for question level analysis which informs planning. The robust use of summative assessment is a key priority of school. Termly pupil progress meetings in year groups analyse performance data and assessment and agree actions for pupils who are not making expected progress. Pupil's welfare, behaviour and attendance is also tracked at weekly pastoral team meetings and this data/discussion is shared with class teachers to check on its effect on learning, if any, particularly for vulnerable groups.

Curriculum design is very intentional to allow for deep exploration of themes which build on prior learning. Leaders are able to discuss the intent of the curriculum and how this will develop over time to include more links to the wider world, world of work and life skills. Subject leads regularly review their subjects and complete 100 day plans to focus on a key focus which allows them to plan the development or monitoring.

Subject leads deliver CPD sessions and updates and regularly communicate via email to ensure that staff are able to revisit key messages. Leaders know and understand the context of the school and the ambition to provide a wide range of experiences and opportunities to enhance the lives of children and enable them to make secure connections between their learning and their experiences which in turn supports conceptual understanding of the curriculum. Leaders know that coverage of the National Curriculum is a minimum requirement and that the ambition at Drake is to exceed the National Curriculum with our offer. For example all children go swimming every year for 5 - 10 sessions depending on year group. Our arts provision and cultural capital opportunities are of an exceptional standard and as a result we achieved the Platinum Artsmark in 2023. Computing at Drake follows a scheme which supports skill development and this year we are working on use and application across subjects. However, in addition to this, lunch time and after school opportunities allow the children to learn advanced coding and children use Python which is beyond the expectation for Primary school.

The sequence and design of the curriculum has been carefully constructed. the theme approach rather than topics allows for exploration of key questions which can build on prior knowledge and experiences. We have continued to refine the curriculum, this year adding Lyfta as a resources to learn about the wider world. The curriculum is still in early stages of implementation due to a focus on the recovery curriculum and wellbeing following school closures due to Covid.

The school has recently federated and as such, has a new Governing Body who are revisiting the MVA of the Federation. In line with this, a review of the school MVA will take place. Currently leaders are planning the inclusion of sustainability and a digital world along with life skills and the world of work as we respond to the needs of the local community to continue to raise aspirations. Summer Term 2023 will see a review of the curriculum and preparations ready for refinements in September 2024 as we continue to make sure that the curriculum is relevant for the pupil community.

Over the course of study, teaching is designed to help pupils to remember long term the content they have been taught and to integrate new knowledge into larger ideas.

SLT meet weekly and curriculum is a standing agenda item. Monitoring and discussions ensure that all leaders understand the focus for development and key priorities for individual subjects and the school. Subject leads are given time to develop and monitor their subjects and are invited to SLT meetings to discuss their subjects. Mid year reviews allow for the discussion of 100 day plans, successes, challenges and next steps for improvement or development opportunities. Our engagement in CPD, work with external consultants and ongoing projects, keep our curriculum relevant, contextual and in line with best practice.

SLT shared observation of lessons for performance management and understand strengths and weaknesses of teaching across school. SLT and subject leads have undertaken book looks and AH review MTPs. Subject leaders are continue to review progress across school in their areas and have developed subject action plans. Data reports are generated for Maths, Reading, science and Phonics termly and other curriculum leads create reports for Governors throughout the year.

Currently leaders are planning the inclusion of sustainability and a digital world along with life skills and the world of work as we respond to the needs of the local community to continue to raise aspirations. Summer Term 2024 is our annual overall review of the curriculum and preparations ready for refinements in September 2024 as we continue to create a curriculum is relevant for the pupil community.

The curriculum offer at Drake is exceptional and in no way narrows the curriculum. With a strong investment in the arts, sports and cultural experiences, all staff understand the high ambitions for the children at school and the need for enrichment and

wide opportunities. Timetables and website evidence capture the range of opportunities and learning provided including cultural capital opportunities. Drake pursues the goal of providing an education beyond the National Curriculum and believe that these opportunities must be accessible by all children. This is why all children, over the course of their education will have opportunities to learn from musicians and play an instrument, not only those who can afford additional lessons. All children go swimming, have forest school, engage in projects outside of school and attend trips and visits. Whole school events widen these opportunities further engaging not only with their class but with their community.

Planning and book scrutiny ensure that the curriculum is suitably sequenced and allows for the acquisition of skills and knowledge over time. Leaders understand the challenges faced by teachers when striving to provide such an ambitious curriculum and appreciate the efforts and dedication required for effective implementation. When challenges are faced, staff are supported and sometimes leaders mitigate with strategies that support workload and coverage without reducing the overall ambition.

The ongoing assessment of curriculum coverage and connections between areas of learning are an area of focus for leaders. Work in books, for some subjects, does not fully capture the learning that has taken place and where this is identified, staff are being supported.

The broad and ambitious curriculum ensures that during any week, children are exposed to a wide variety of learning opportunities. Challenge and pitch ensures that children are producing work of the expected quality in most lessons. Productivity in subjects such as maths have improved significantly whereas in some other subjects this is still developing. However, over time, children are able to demonstrate their learning in different ways. For example, by creating a podcast for the radio, demonstrating skills to other teachers.

Children with SEND are supported to achieve. Some children working significantly below expectation follow the Norfolk Assessment Pathway Curriculum completing this work and then engaging in other more self-directed tasks which support independence, fine motor skills, perseverance or other skills related to their individual plans. Bespoke timetables are also in place for the children in the SRB with a blend of academic learning and social, emotional, communication and interaction support according to individual targets.

Teachers are expected to use formative assessment within lessons to support the learning of pupils. In the moment feedback is expected rather than marking books after the lessons have finished to enable the children to respond to feedback immediately. This skill is developing. In some lessons, teachers do not intervene quickly enough to prevent a misconception being repeated or move learning on challenging pupils appropriately. In some lessons this can be addressed well with visualiser stops so that feedback is given to the whole class.

Termly summative assessments are used to ascertain progress and attainment. Teachers are encouraged to consider point in time assessment. However, more focus on application evidence is now required to form the teacher assessment including the summative assessments for Maths, English and Science. QLA is completed once assessments are marked and this information is used to inform planning.

EY and KS1 results are consistent with the Drake expectations of pupils. GLD and Phonics data consistently exceed National averages over the last 5 years. In Year 2, results are in line with expectations.

Whilst rapidly improving end of KS2 results do not yet reflect the educational offer of the school. Actions for this year will address this area of concern to ensure that pupils' knowledge and skills across the curriculum is accurately reflected in results in year 6 from national tests and examinations that meet government expectations.

Drake works with external consultants to ensure that literacy and numeracy development is in line with best practice. These skills are taught within the core subject lessons and school explore ways to make more use of these across the curriculum. For example the work in maths surrounding statistics supports longitudinal projects in science which can be presented through spreadsheets and graphs in computing. For this purpose, we have redeployed subject leadership into a teamed approach as STEM.

English skills are also maximised throughout the curriculum and now that our Talk4Writing and Talk4Reading programmes are better established, teachers are planning to build on the children's learning from the Autumn Term to consolidate skills in the Spring and Summer - for example year 2 will be able to create instructions for a curriculum purpose once they have learned the skills and toolkits in English. Reading longer texts related to curriculum knowledge is a piece of work planned to be undertaken by the English lead and subject leads.

School uses Pupil Asset to track all pupils from EYFS, KS1, KS2 and yearly starting points and to answer questions about any groups or individuals. Pupils are given termly summative (linked to PIT) assessments based on their year group objectives, as

well as formative and summative assessments. Termly pupil progress meetings in year groups analyse performance data and assessment and agree actions for pupils who are not making expected progress. Pupil's welfare, behaviour and attendance is also tracked at weekly pastoral team meetings and this data/discussion is shared with class teachers to check on its impact on learning, if any, particularly for vulnerable groups.

Pupil progress is strong and the evidence for this continues to build as the assessment process is refined and becomes more accurate increasing the validity of progress over time. Current year 6 test data confirms the work of leaders to secure improving outcomes is successful. All leaders are fully engaged in working with any groups of children who may not meet expected year end outcomes.

Strengths

- Pupils study a full, enriching and aspirational curriculum
- Regular SLT discussion and sharing of information ensures that focus areas are identified and support strategies are agreed and put in place.
- Leadership is highly effective in closing gaps including for those children who are disadvantaged or SEND
- Reading is prioritised to allow pupils to access the full curriculum offer
- The school's curriculum intent and implement are embedded throughout the school

Opportunities for development

- Outcomes at the end of key stage 2 continue to improve
- The most disadvantaged pupils and those with SEND achieve exceptionally well
- Across the school, series of lessons continue to deepen understanding across subject areas
- Refining the use of planning sequences

Behaviour and Attitudes

JUDGEMENT



The school has high expectations for pupils; behaviour and conduct in the majority of classes is strong. These expectations are commonly understood and applied consistently and fairly. This is reflected in pupils' positive behaviour and conduct. Low-level disruption is generally not tolerated and pupils' behaviour does not disrupt lessons or the day-to-day life of the school. Staff are well supported by leaders and the pastoral team in managing pupil behaviour. Staff make sure that pupils follow appropriate routines when following the behaviour policy. Pupils attitudes to their education are positive. They are developing commitment to their learning, and learning how to study effectively and take pride in their achievements. Relationships among pupils and staff reflect a positive and respectful culture. Pupils are safe and they feel safe. Our significant pastoral team works closely together, with children, families and external agencies to meet the needs of the children. The specialism within the team ensures a wide perspective and helps navigate which support is most appropriate, for example EAL, family, behaviour, SEMH or SEND.

Through the establishment of positive relationships underpinned by our school values, Drake has a culture of respect and support. This results in children being keen to behave and support others. Children know the school rules well and are able to adhere to them, challenging themselves to take on responsibility and accountability for their behaviour. For example, the radio council often work unsupervised in the media room carrying out their role and responsibilities. They do this not for fear of sanction or to seek reward but because they value the process and the independence and responsibility bestowed upon them.

Classes are calm and productive yet filled with an excitement and eagerness to learn and undertake tasks and activities. Talk partner and group work encourages collaboration and negotiation between pupils as well as conflict resolution on occasions.

Our behaviour policy is followed by staff and strategies are consistently applied. A few children in school have a differentiated approach, these children have a Individual Risk Management plan or Pastoral Support Plan known by staff. Behaviour at break times has improved with the inclusion of more structured opportunities, especially during lunch time. The pastoral team, who discuss vulnerable children and those displaying patterns of behaviour monitor children at different times throughout the day as well as during break times to support planning to meet individuals' needs.

Attendance at Drake is above National and this is supported through the children's enjoyment of school and pupil engagement. SLT and the pastoral team work closely together to monitor attendance and strategize to support individual children ad families. The Parent Support Advisor works very closely with families and also the attendance team to offer bespoke support and guidance.

Attendance is celebrated weekly in assembly and children are well motivated to attend. The winning class is reported in the weekly newsletter along with whole school weekly attendance. The vast majority of families understand the importance of regular attendance. Parents understand the procedure for requesting leave and that holidays are not authorised during term time. Punctuality is also monitored and the PSA works with families regarding this. Families are discussed in pastoral meetings and strategies are put in place.

Pupils value their education, most absence is parental request. Pupils have high attendance, come to school on time and are punctual to lessons. When this is not the case, the school takes appropriate, swift and effective action. The Pastoral Team meets weekly and analyses the attendance data looking at trends and repeated absence children. First letters are sent to parents when a child falls below the 95% attendance and the school's PSA meets with parents to discuss the reasons for poor attendance and how as a school we can make improvements. The main group of children with attendance issues is KS2 SEND. Persistent absence of a child who is awaiting another school placement has affected this significantly

Leaders, staff and pupils create a positive environment in which bullying is not tolerated. If bullying, aggression, discrimination and derogatory language occur, they are dealt with quickly and effectively and are not allowed to spread. Pupils are safe and feel safe they know their voice is heard when we investigate any incidents and collect voice from all children involved. They have opportunities to learn how to keep themselves safe and how to prevent misuse of technology. Leaders provide good

information and respond appropriately to concerns. Pupils repeatedly report their positive experiences of school but do acknowledge that at times, children can be unkind to others. Children feel that teachers respond to these situations to keep children safe.

Children are taught explicitly about safeguarding themselves and how to share concerns if something happens in school, out of school or online. The RSHE curriculum and computing curriculum directly target these issues and they are further explored through our school values and personal safety aspects of worship. Development of the RSHE curriculum to include cross school strategies including the zones of regulation will enhance this further.

The pastoral team monitor behaviour closely and where there are issues of repeated behaviours, action plans are created to respond in partnership with teachers and families. The team work with other agencies to seek support, particularly if a child is receiving fixed term exclusions.

Where there are issues, staff respond appropriately and quickly. On occasions, when children have exhibited persistent challenging behaviours, these are monitored and dealt with. Other children are supported to be understanding and relationship support through RSHE sessions are conducted.

The school's approach to fixed term exclusion is related closely to our behaviour policy and pathway. Exclusions may be issued as a result of serious or persistent behaviours. In each instance, communication and partnership with parents is established as far as possible. Reintegration meetings make expectations clear to pupils and parents and agreements of strategies to be in place support the child to be successful. Where children might become a risk of permanent exclusion, partnership with parents and external agencies would ensure that this is a last resort.

In order to prevent permanent exclusion, SLT have worked with families to improve behaviours through a pastoral support plan, engaged with the local authority to provide suitable alternative provision or movement to complex needs school and explored the managed move process. Permanent exclusions are used appropriately as a last resort in consultation with families and external agencies. In all instances, the best interests of the child remain at the centre of practice and decision making alongside the wellbeing of the other pupils in school. At all stages, our approach remains child focused and solution based.

Strengths

- The school has high expectations for pupils' behaviour and conduct. These expectations are commonly understood and applied consistently and fairly
- The excellent relationships among pupils and staff reflect a positive and respectful culture; pupils are safe and they feel safe
- Pupils' consistent positive attitudes and commitment to their education demonstrates that they are highly motivated and persistent in the face of difficulties. Pupils make highly positive, tangible contribution to the life of the school and/or the wider community. Pupils actively support the well-being of other pupils
- Pupils behave consistently well, with high levels of self-control and positive attitudes. Highly effective action to support them to succeed in their education where children find this more challenging in collaboration with external agencies and professionals

Opportunities for development

- Staff continue to develop their understanding of what a differentiated pathway looks like and why it is sometimes necessary. This will include the continued training and development for SEND/SEMH/Trauma informed best practice
- Development of the RSHE curriculum to include the zones of regulation

Personal Development

JUDGEMENT



Throughout the wide range of opportunities and experiences that is provided for the pupils at Drake, they are supported to develop their individuality, character and personalities whilst understanding their own responsibilities to support their personal development. Our positive relationships with the children support them to navigate the world around them, exploring risks and challenges and developing the resourcefulness, resilience and independence required for them to excel. They understand risks within the real, and digital worlds and are encouraged to understand and appreciate that their own experience, viewpoint and lifestyle will differ to others, within school, the local community and the world. Through this they develop tolerance and acceptance and have respect for others from a range of backgrounds and abilities and for those with interests and beliefs that differ to their own.

Our curriculum, including enhanced experiences and opportunities support the development of well-rounded, responsible, and engaged members of the school and community. Children are given responsibility and are held to account for this. For example, our radio council broadcast daily at lunch time and are expected to be on time, understand their role and the expectations and to implement these often without the direct input and support of a teacher. Children are actively encouraged to share their views and support leadership to shape their school. A blue-sky activity with school council allowed them the opportunity to share their successes and visions for school development. Eco-council have worked diligently to share information about the environment and the role of the school and community. They have clear targets which support their projects against which they can evaluate their own impact. Across school, more than a quarter of the pupils are within a school council and all pupil groups are represented.

Our school values, encompassing British values, are at the heart of all we do at Drake and then are embedded within our curriculum and processes. For example, individual liberty and democracy through our pupil councils and election processes, our focus on courageous advocacy and social justice underpin our school value of Courage and Trust. Understanding, tolerance and acceptance are the foundation of our values and are taught through values days, RE, RSHE, and through religions, faith and other protective characteristics being explored throughout our curriculum including challenging and though provoking key questions and concepts. Our classes and rooms are named after a diverse range of inspirational people and they are used as role models who have shaped our history and our future. The rule of law is supported through designed discussions and understanding of right and wrong and these discussions progress throughout school in a range of subjects including English, history, RE and RSHE. From early on, children are earning about their rights and their responsibilities within school and their communities.

Our school values underpin our learning and this relates to understanding of the school rules and expectations. The children know and follow these well. They explore what rules might mean in various contexts to ensure that they not only follow rules because they are in place but because the children know right from wrong and can act with integrity. They are able to hold themselves to the highest standard, for example listening to and following instructions as a rule could be interpreted further by the understanding of the responsibility to fully understand the instruction and to be resourceful and accountable when following it to the best of our ability. Our RSHE curriculum and collective worship allows the exploration of some complex issues and through this, staff are able to support discussions about contextual safeguarding so that children understand the threats and risks within their community and are supported to navigate them.

The school behaviour policy is understood well by staff and is used to support positive learning behaviours. Behaviour logs are monitored and regulated by the pastoral team and the Lead Behaviour Professional supports teachers with serious incident letters and communications with parents. Where behaviours are serious or persistent, processes such as a pastoral support plan are initiated. Close work with the Local Authority ensures that provisions are in place for children and sanctions are applied appropriately.

All staff receive annual training on Safeguarding and Prevent. They are aware of the indicators of radicalisation. The pastoral team in collaboration with a range of external agencies to support and monitor families including Inclusion Team, Attendance

Team, Mental Health Team, Young Carers Team to monitor and support our most vulnerable pupils when identified and as necessary liaise with safeguarding professionals and the police. We have a number of staff DSL trained to ensure the highest level of vigilance and understanding in school and a dedicated DSL team. Our safeguarding Governor understands policy and practice and all Governors complete their own training annually.

Children are regularly taught about appropriate behaviour and how to navigate relationships through our Early Years PSED and our RSHE scheme, ensuring that this is accessible to all using tools such as social stories to convey the key messages. This includes an understanding of bullying and what to do if bullying is experienced or witnesses. Anti-bullying week allows for coverage of these issues. Work is often undertaken to help children understand what constitutes bullying. Accusations of bullying are taken seriously, investigated and acted upon.

Online safety is taught half termly with aspects of teaching being directed by assessments undertaken by the children to ensure that the most prevalent issues are dealt with and positive messages are reinforced. Parent cafes in 2022/23 have been online safety focussed with this being the planned theme of Cafes in the Spring Term in 23/24. We understand the important role that parents play in keeping their children safe but also the speed at which technology is posing risk and that some families are less confident understanding and addressing these. Information leaflets are shared in newsletters and available at the school office/reception area. Where children access alternate or offsite provision, we are in contact and complete the necessary safeguarding checks.

Curriculum design includes opportunities and experiences which support children's mental health, physical, social and emotional development as well as academic achievement and support classes to have shared experiences to create a sense of belonging and community. For example, in September 2023, we had a whole school trip to High Lodge in Thetford Forest. We have also engaged with the Mental Health Support Trust to provide workshops and support for children and regularly reflect on aspects of mental health include sleep, healthy eating, physical exercise etc. Not only is the wellbeing of children important, but also our staff who have received training which can support their own mental health and their ability to support children and families. Many of our staff team, have chosen to undertake further training in this area. The zones of regulation strategy is used across school to help children to recognise and manage their emotions including general and bespoke strategies they can use to regulate. Our nurture groups and interventions such as forest school, ELSA, drawing and talking and Lego therapy also support children with specific challenges.

Drake children benefit from a daily run, regular PE slot, annual swimming, other sporting events across the year. Children are reminded about the importance of health and fitness for a healthy lifestyle. Our school kitchen has been awarded Silver Food for Life which recognises our locally sourced and organic produce, healthy menu choices and promotion of healthy living. Our SNAC team (School nutrition action committee) work on the promotion of healthy foods and cooking activities, this is in the early stages of development and implementation.

Individuality and character are evidenced throughout the school, children are encouraged to be themselves and are supported to navigate this through kindness and respect for others. This is also modelled by an eclectic staff team who are valued highly. Children are offered a wide range of opportunities and experiences across different curriculum areas in the aim for them to find their interests and passions, whatever they may be. Once found, we encourage and promote this, supporting children to have high aspirations and a strong work ethic through perseverance and resilience in order to achieve it. Our inspirational people are highlighted throughout the children's education but they are encouraged to find their own inspiration through historical and current significant people including those known to them. Our afterschool clubs further give opportunities for children to engage with something of their choosing with a wide range on offer including sports, science, chess, cheerleading, book folding, art, choir, coding, craft, gardening and role play gaming. We ensure that staff run clubs that they are also interested in, modelling the passion and enthusiasm for wider curriculum activities. Most of these are free to access and delivered by teachers. Where external companies are used, there is a small charge to families. The pastoral team monitors engagement of disadvantaged pupils to ensure that opportunities are accessible and they are being accessed, we do this by ensuring our young carers group (which meets weekly) have an opportunity to similar access activities as we recognise that after school opportunities were not a commonly accessed by this group of pupils.

Children share that they feel valued and liked and the positive relationships throughout school demonstrate this well. Children play and socialise together positively and collaboratively and are supported if necessary when they have disagreements. Children understand that they should treat everyone with kindness and respect even if they do not have shared interests.

Children are supported well in school to see and consider a range of possibilities for their lives. Through the curriculum, stories and books, they are exposed to significant people related to particular careers or qualities. We endeavour to provide trips and visitors which further inspire and help children to consider wider options for them as they progress through their lives, for example we have been visited by authors, artists, scientists, historians, chefs, musicians, environmentalists and professors.

As we continue to refine our approach to the development of each child, our use of Lyfta as a learning platform further illustrates themes, issues and lifestyles across the world. We have also registered for a careers related learning programme which will enable us to work more closely with industries to educate and inform children about the workforce and challenge stereotypical views.

Last year, we attended a careers event 'skills escalation day' for Year 2 children and this year Year 5 attended a manufacturing day with a local business. In school, visiting opportunities and collaboration between settings also support the transition to the next phase of their education. This year we have established a closer partnership with the local high school for opportunities such as: SLT visiting our Year 7 pupils, Year 6 children attending a musical event and performances.

At Drake, our range of experiences is extensive and as far as possible supported by experts for quality assurance. Trips and visits including residential include:

- Whole school trip to high lodge with a range of curriculum and sporting opportunities
- museum visits
- library
- farms and sanctuaries
- churches
- experience days
- sporting events including skill development or competitions
- performance opportunities
- watching performances of others
- puppet theatre
- botanical gardens
- industry opportunities
- adventurous activity
- Travel to other counties/countries (France)
- Visitors include
- scientists
- environmentalists
- historians
- sports people (last year we had Lily Woodham visit)
- local musician workshops
- authors
- maths workshops
- visitors for collective worship

All pupils attend our trips and visits and the donations made are voluntary. Once payments are received, school calculates the shortfall to determine the viability of the trip and where/how remaining costs can be covered by the school.

In addition, through our main curriculum we also provide a range of opportunities for art and music. Our involvement with the Norfolk Music Hub and our musicians in residence ensure that our children receive music education of an extremely high quality. All children at Drake learn to play an instrument and this culminates in UKS2 as they are able to choose an instrument to learn for a year or two at no cost to the parents. Instruments are provided for the children so that they can practice at home and support their skills development. Additional private lessons can also be paid for.

All children at Drake, throughout the year will also have opportunities to learn in our Forest School area and go swimming. Our forest school provision is key in supporting wellbeing, independence and resilience as well as supporting our school curriculum in line with the mission, vision and aims. It is an expectation that all staff at Drake have completed or will complete Level 1 training through the guidance of our skilled Forest School Lead who is an accredited trainer. This wider commitment to the ethos of outdoor learning means that all staff share the vision for play based, holistic learning and understand the full value of this type of learning. The children attend Forest school in all weathers and look forward to this part of their week.

Our school Head Boy and Head Girl, supported by the prefects, role model expectations throughout our school. They support the celebration assembly weekly and are ambassadors for the school. This year, they have started to contribute to the weekly newsletter for parents sharing their own observations of weekly events.

Each class has nominated peer mentors who was selected for their qualities and attributes for being a good role model and supportive of others. Their role is to support others in school, particularly at break times, be a listening ear or someone to go to if you are lonely, they support children who are new to the school and who find making friends challenging.

- Our councils include School (general), Eco, Sport, Tech, Radio, Art, Play, EAL, SNAC, Diversity, Sanctuary and Medical councils. These allow for children to follow their interests and engage within a pupil leadership role. They attend meetings to learn about the focus and agree plans for the year then work collaboratively to achieve them. This teaches the children about commitment and responsibility, accountability, sharing information with stakeholders, presentation skills and being ambassadors for the school. They are able to impact upon the school and pupils and make a difference, for example:
- Eco council worked towards a target of reducing waste which resulted in a change of system for the disposal of food waste in school.
- Sports Council requested a change of PE kit to include a hoodie. They also wanted our school houses to be more clearly defined. As a result, our PE kit is now the colour of their house and a PE Hoodie has been introduced. Sports Council also carried our fundraising and used some of the money to provide a PE shirt to every new reception child in September 2023.
- Following a swimming gala, a new swim team has been introduced in school. the children have dedicated sessions to competitive skills and techniques and then some fun competition. They compete with other local schools
- Radio Council wanted to increase their listeners and now broadcast 'Live at Lunch' daily which is played outside for the children to enjoy. They have developed a system to allow for pupils to interact, send in ideas and answers that are then shared on the radio
- Peer mentors have created a buddy bench so that children have somewhere to go if they need support. They raised money to have a peer mentor hoodie so that they are able to be identified easily by the other children.
- Effective use is made of our sports premium money to cover additional sensory circuit sessions for pupils, sporting opportunities, competitive sports and swimming for Reception and key stage 1.

Strengths

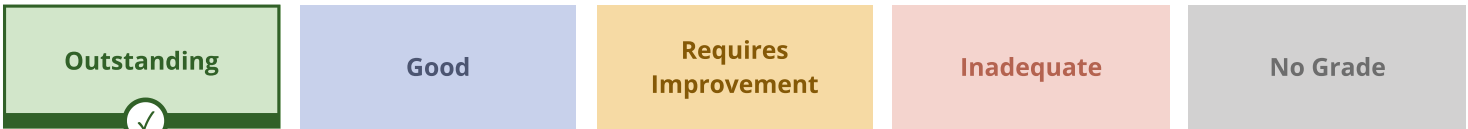
- Our curriculum extends beyond academic skills
- We consistently promote the extensive personal development of pupils and go beyond the expected, so that pupils have access to a wide, rich set of experiences. Opportunities for pupils to develop their talents and interests are of exceptional quality. These are provided through the curriculum and through extra-curricular activities, and they considerably strengthen the school's offer.
- Opportunities for children to develop a sense of responsibility through councils
- The value for individuals including their personality and character is excellent and radiates throughout the school

Opportunities for development

- The planning of experiences is mapped out across the year and balanced which supports planning and preparation
- Development of Lyfta and Careers Related Learning projects (as these are still in early stages).

Leadership and Management

JUDGEMENT



Leaders at Drake have the track record of demonstrating the capacity to support and challenge the staff at school to provide the best outcomes for children, both at Drake and other schools. Leaders have a clear mission, vision and aims rooted in the need for children in the locality to develop their aspirations and inspirations, the leadership team drive an inspiring and experience rich education for children, helping them to discover and develop their passions and interests, develop a curiosity in the world around them, consider opportunities and the need for social justice and courageous advocacy and to be prepared for the modern, digital world. The robust recruitment of staff ensures that staff are value aligned and ambitious for high quality outcomes and the school values of the school permeate through all we do. Staff are supported by clear rules and guidance including the code of conduct and school charter and use these to be transparent, hold each other to account and provide professional challenge. This is modelled and supported by leaders consistently. Subject leads are empowered to undertake their own research, engage with professionals and make decisions about their subjects. SLT aims to develop local decision makers and support the independence of subject leads whilst maintaining supportive monitoring and guidance. Subject leads are released from teaching regularly to ensure that they are able to carry out their roles effectively with most having time on alternate weeks and some subjects receiving weekly time. Teachers feel supported and encouraged to ask for additional time, resources and support that is needed for them to carry out their roles.

Regular SLT meetings include monitoring and feedback to staff to ensure that the highest expectations are centre to our practice. Whilst understanding that some staff need direct support with aspects of their work, all school staff are expected to strive for outstanding practice. This includes actively engaging in CPD and seeking out resources and opportunities to enhance the practice of themselves and others thus impacting positively on outcomes for children. For example, the SRB specialists support the implementation of a range of practices supporting all children and families in school, including those with SEND. This has also helped staff to understand neurodivergence of pupils and families. In addition to the annual safeguarding training and development required, a number of staff are currently undertaking National Professional Qualifications and this is actively encouraged for those in role and those aspiring. The development and growth of the staff team is valued and the professional development of staff is supported through the use of a career stage expectation, career pathway meetings using a career progression document and targets set through performance management. Staff actively request CPD in relation to their interests and needs and can access this through training, for example mental health champion training or enhanced opportunities, for example a member of support staff expressed an interest in young carers and now runs young carer sessions. We have also seen the development of our support staff training to be teachers and often retain trainees once qualified where vacancies are available. Where staff express an interest in leadership, opportunities are created appropriately in line with the career development pathway. This has included enhanced responsibilities such as mentoring, involvement in recruitment, leading networks, event management, curriculum development, budget monitoring, DSL training, training for trainers CPD and secondments. School leaders themselves attend high quality training including NAHT CPD, NPQH, Leader's conferences, New Head's Induction training, Church of England Leadership of Diversity and Inclusion to model the need for ongoing development and training. We have been accepted as a host school for the Leaders Like Us programme starting in the Spring for aspiring leaders needing mentors to increase diverse representations of leaders in education. Staff report that Drake is a positive place to work, full of energy, ambition and professionalism and transforming the lives of children. Drake is child centred and put the needs of the children at the heart of all we do and this motivation drives the practice of our staff. The views of stakeholders are sought to ensure that the school meets the needs of the pupils and the community. Our longer strategy is focused on providing inspiration to drive aspiration and ensure that children have the skills to be successful citizens and contribute to the world of work.

The weekly staff CPD is mapped out for the year but then adapted and developed as the year progresses to ensure that training and support is responsive to the needs of the school, pupils and staff. Both internal and external expertise is used to quality assure aspects of the professional development offered to staff subject leaders all have an active part in the development of their subjects through CPD and monitoring both independently and within SLT meetings. We are currently developing opportunities for formal and informal collaboration with pour partner school and other schools in the local area. Drake supports the development of teachers in other schools, for example offering art CPD and partnership projects,

Talk4writing, PE and computing. Connections with the local High School is broadening opportunities, for example our Year 6 children joined with High School Pupils to play in an orchestra together, radio council students take part in projects across school and visit other schools and report on a wide range of events. School leaders are collaborating further to explore the reciprocal opportunities to develop pupils of both sites and opportunities for staff to work together.

Workload and mental wellbeing is monitored by SLT with weekly considerations of individual staff and supportive strategies put in place. Where initiatives and school developments are sought, the additional workload is considered and mitigated, without reducing our ambitions for children. For example, staff planning needed developing. Initially we focused on core subjects and then once established, the science planning format was adopted within other subjects. This carefully planned approach allowed staff to become more effective in their planning but in manageable steps. Planning was supported by subject leads and exemplification supported the development of skills. To enhance the opportunities for children, we aimed to introduce staff led clubs free of charge for pupils following the restrictions in place due to Covid. Teachers were asked to lead a club a week and selected their own club based on their own interests. As a result, both staff and pupils enjoy their clubs and comment on the benefits for wellbeing. Staff share the responsibility to support workload and to ensure that clubs can still take place in case of absence.

Staff wellbeing is regularly discussed. All staff fully engaged in wellbeing training directed at their own mental health and many undertook further study about supporting children. Wellbeing is regularly referred to in staff briefing with practical ideas to support staff such as leaving on time, managing marking to reduce the need for marking in the evenings, careful planning ahead to ensure management of occurring extras such as parents evening, assessments and events. A visual reminder display in the staff room supports staff further and a named Mental Health Champion actively engages with members of staff as required.

Staff report their wellbeing is enhanced by the opportunities to lead in areas of interest in addition to the professional development offered for areas of leadership. Regular career pathway meetings support teachers and support staff in planning career aspirations, career stage expectations ensure equity in opportunity. Staff are encouraged to undertake NPQs with 9 staff having just completed or currently undertaking one. Staff are supported with both masters' degrees and PhD study.

All leaders have weekly supervision meetings. Supervision lasts one hour and is in 3 parts it is designed to ensure leaders develop the necessary leadership tools to work effectively, increase leadership capacity to enable Halcyon's mission vision and aims to become a reality.

All leaders are part of professional organisations and nationally accredited networks, leaders explore partnerships locally, regionally and nationally. Leaders work with the education, business and voluntary sector to design projects that enhance the provision for students.

SLT completed blue sky events with children, parents and staff to gather their views about the school. These have been collated and SLT will reporting key findings and associated actions. Already, in newsletters, information about the activities of leaders is included to help parents to see what monitoring and support is in place in school. As a result of a parent Governor Comment at the end Summer 2022/23 stating that parents did not understand maths strategies used in school, maths became the focus of parent cafes in the Autumn Term. Parents already receive written information about calculation strategies. Our strategies document is currently being updated but will then be shared with parents to further support them at home. Pupil and Parent voice is gathered by subject leads throughout the year and our pupil councils provide valuable support for leaders in creating the school that pupils want.

Leaders complete self-evaluations and share with stakeholders. Evidence is gathered from a range of sources and agreed between leaders. These are shared with Governors who are able to ask additional questions and offer support and challenge. Areas for development are based on any issues and reflections, areas for planned developments such as projects and reflection against standards and good practice. With the current aim to meet requirements for Outstanding for the next OFSTED inspection, the grade descriptors have been used to assess performance and identify areas which are not fully evidenced or embedded.

Having recently federated, Governance of the school is newly formed. Many of the existing governors applied as co-opted governors and 2 new parent governors were added alongside a member of the business community as a new Chair. This is further supported by the Local Authority. Regular meetings relating to safeguarding, curriculum or finance are held and reports provided by the Executive Head, Heads of School and curriculum leaders as required. Prior to Federation, Governors monitored provision in school, meeting with leaders and completing reports. Governors are very clear about their responsibilities and bring a good range of expertise to their roles, they share the high expectations of the schools leaders.

Drake has a culture of strong safeguarding practice. All documentation and record keeping is exact, staff are fully aware of the signs of potential abuse and they report their concerns. Leaders and staff work effectively with external partners to help pupils who are at risk or who are the subject of a multi-agency plan. Leaders promote equality of opportunity and diversity exceptionally well, for pupils and staff, so that the ethos and culture of the whole school counters any form of direct or indirect discriminatory behaviour.

Leaders, staff and pupils do not tolerate prejudiced behaviour. Recruitment policies and practices are managed to ensure that children are protected. The recruitment process actively ensures that staff who join the school are value aligned and committed to the wellbeing of children. Leaders understand their duties and policies and procedures are reviewed regularly. Governors ratify policies before they are released and have the opportunity to ask questions and make comments. Leaders understand protective characteristics and actively ensure that behaviours and systems do not discriminate. Our recruitment processes are not prejudiced, applications and current staff workforce shares the inclusive ethos of our school and ensures that everyone is welcomed and valued, there is currently good reflection of the protective characteristics.

Staff understand school code of conduct and expectations and know that adherence to this non-negotiable and for the best interests of the whole school community. All training is in line with KCSIE and all documentation is amended appropriately. There are clear records of staff having read at least part one of KCSIE and this can be evidenced in their practice. Prevent is reviewed regularly with staff completing the online training.

All staff receive a safeguarding induction a checklist highlighting the safeguarding guidance given to staff and volunteers. All staff receive the following documents as part of this induction: School's safeguarding ; child protection policy Staff code of conduct Behaviour Policy, School's safeguarding response to children who go missing from education part one; Annex A of 'Keeping Children Safe in Education Information about the DSLs. Staff receive child protection, ACE, Prevent training as part of their induction. The school retains evidence of staff induction. Supply staff, contractors, volunteers and visitors also receive key safeguarding information; please describe what form this takes in your school. The DSL and deputy DSLs have received suitable training in line with national and local requirements. Additionally other staff are trained as DSLs to ensure that there is a high level of vigilance around school whilst the daily safeguarding decisions and actions are made by the DSL team. In addition to the whole school safeguarding training, Early Years teams undertake additional safeguarding training and support from the pastoral team/additional DSL/SENDCO, they undertake home visits and work closely with wider agencies. All staff use CPOMs.

Outcomes and children's well-being are at the heart of all we do at Drake. The breadth of the curriculum is far reaching and opportunities are available for all. Inclusivity is our strength and we remained child focused and solution focused at all times. We work closely with external agencies to ensure that the staff team meet the needs of children and where the child's needs exceed what is possible in school that appropriate actions are taken to get the support that they need. Drake has a reputation for success in integration of students with SEMH/SEND. In the last year we have welcome 4 managed moves.

Strengths

- Leaders ensure that teachers receive focused and highly effective professional development. Teachers' subject, pedagogical and pedagogical content knowledge consistently build and develop over time. This consistently translates into improvements in the teaching of the curriculum
- Leaders ensure that highly effective and meaningful engagement takes place with staff at all levels and that issues are identified. When issues are identified, in particular about workload, they are consistently dealt with appropriately and quickly.
- Staff consistently report high levels of support for well-being issues.
- Leaders engage effectively with pupils and others in their community, including, when relevant, parents, employers and local services. Engagement opportunities are focused and have purpose.
- Leaders are highly effective at training new leaders

Opportunities for Development

- Those responsible for governance understand their role and carry this out effectively. Governors/trustees ensure that the school has a clear vision and strategy, that resources are managed well and that leaders are held to account for the quality of education
- Induction of new leaders to Drake and Halcyon including through the 'Leaders Like Us' programme
- Share best practice at a regional, national and global level

Early Years

JUDGEMENT



Early Years at Drake are valued as the earliest opportunities to engage children and nurture their curiosity and love of the world building the strong foundations for their lifelong learning. The curriculum design ensures opportunities to introduce and develop a range of skills with a particular focus of PSED and CL on entry into school. Other learning areas are quickly introduced with phonics lessons, talk 4 writing and maths input which is then maximised through continuous provision opportunities and enhancements.

The curriculum was designed for the implementation of the new curriculum in 2021 following training with Early Excellence. This training was attended by nursery staff, reception teachers and SLT.

The Early Years Curriculum is rooted in the opportunities to build on the interests of the children yet still meet the requirements of the curriculum. In line with the overall school curriculum, it includes key concepts and questions, opportunities to make connections and to learn about the wider world.

Themes - People and communities; Stories, rhymes and morals; The World

These themes allow for all aspects of the EYFS Curriculum to be taught in a purposeful and engaging way whilst still allowing flexibility to respond to the needs and interests of the children. Children follow the sequences for planning as set out for the rest of the school and engage with Talk4Writing and NCETM maths.

Open ended opportunities and learning through play enhance opportunities for children to make connections and apply their learning whilst being actively engaged through play and exploration, thinking critically and collaborating with others. We are currently developing our outdoor provision to support this further.

All children in Reception have opportunities during the year to engage in PE, Forest school and swimming. Their bespoke woodland area and training of staff to support outdoor learning increases the opportunities to engage with their world. Trips and opportunities such as the visiting puppet theatre further enhance and enrich the curriculum and develop the children's cultural capital.

Storytelling began before children even started at school. Staff shared videos telling stories with the children during the summer term and over the summer holidays. Communication via Tapestry (all about me and memos) encouraged parents to share details about children's favourite books. When starting at school, children had small key group activities specifically about handling and respecting books. Children have free access to the book area. Children listen to stories daily in a way that engages and excites them promoting an ethos of reading for pleasure. During the children's first full week in school, the children started taking home a sharing book and a reading diary to record when stories are shared.

Phonics teaching starts quickly once children have settled using RWI. Assessments every half term to assess progress and impact. When individual children are ready, they are given opportunities to start reading sentences and Ditties moving on to Big cat Collins book scheme with a wider range of fiction and nonfiction texts. Stories are fundamental in reception and the children regularly listen to stories. They learn to retell a story through our Talk4Writing programme and then innovate this becoming storytellers themselves.

The theme 'Stories rhymes and morals' allows for children to learn about a range of stories including tales from a range of cultures and also to explore non-fiction. Children learn that books are for pleasure and for information and start to understand their purpose.

Clear mathematical resources in place from as soon as the children start in reception including both indoor and outdoor opportunities. Baseline assessments focused on number recognition, writing, counting, positional language and awareness of shape. Taught input occurs daily along with opportunities to master number through the NCETM intervention programme. Songs and rhymes are used as well as maths stories. Further planned opportunities evident in planning and through

continuous provision. Staff use spontaneous as well as planned opportunities to encourage and support maths skills and evidence this through unplanned observations. The Early Years Lead attends an EY Maths consortium to ensure teaching and provision in line with best practice.

Our focus on early reading and phonics along with the whole school approach to writing and early maths ensures that the children in Reception are part of the wider school initiatives but with Early Years appropriate pedagogy. Staff are supported to maintain their professional development not only for generic subjects but specifically for Early Years. As well as the focus on the areas of development, children's characteristics of effective learning are supported. Children are actively engaged in their play and exploration, asking questions and offering their own hypothesis. Children are encouraged to evaluate their play and make changes accordingly, for example when constructing assault courses, the children assess risk and manage this themselves, often adding to their constructions. Children sustain interest in their play and are self motivated. Staff understand the needs of those that find this most challenging and support them to persevere and develop resilience in an age/stage appropriate manner.

PSED has been planned for the beginning of the year so that children develop a sense of themselves and others along with being a member of the class community. Children are taught to share, take turns and listen to each other with respect and courtesy through modelling and support during play and specific learning opportunities. Children are praised and rewarded for positive and considerate behaviours. Children demonstrate positive behaviours and are supported to self-regulate.

Diversity is embedded in children's learning and all children are reflected through toys, books and learning experiences. Collective worship allows children to learn about the school values and children are taught to respect all faiths and religions. The themes for learning also allow for the exploration of traditions, beliefs and cultural variation. The school community is valued by the children and they recognise various individuals around the school. The initial half term plan includes meeting a range of people in school and finding out about what they do. Other visitors in school and opportunities for trips, further help the children to engage with their community.

The CoEL are taught through attitudes to learning and play tasks. Children are encouraged to question, test ideas, adapt, concentrate, persevere, ask questions etc. Children's patterns of behaviour are noted and planned for.

Adults skilfully observe during the day and engage children as required in either large, small or individual opportunities. Teaching is appropriate for early Years and this results in good learning experiences for the children.

Varied equipment and resources both indoors and out allow children to develop and express their own interests freely so that they can play, explore and learn independently. Different Areas of learning are planned for both indoors and out and children have free access to indoor and outdoor activities throughout most of the day.

Children are well settled in school and respond to the routines and boundaries that are in place. Children develop independence through the expectations throughout the day including selecting their own resources for play, self-help skills and lunch time routines. The experiences and opportunities provided for our youngest pupils demonstrate our overall high expectations for outcomes for children. For example their trips, visitors, performance opportunities and school engagement in forest school and swimming. We are currently seeking opportunities to engage with other schools and opportunities to develop children's cultural capital outside of school.

The strong focus on the best outcomes for each individual child drive our practice. Whilst striving for all children to meet their full potential, we are able to be focused on the end of year expectations and still value the progress made by individuals including those with SEND. SEND reviews, pupil progress meetings and regular opportunities to discuss pupils keeps teachers focussed on what gaps in knowledge and skills children might have and how to best support them to achieve. Information is shared with parents through the sharing of wow moments on Tapestry, the updated website, half termly year group newsletters, weekly whole school newsletters and more formally in parents evenings and an end of year report. Parental engagement through assemblies, cafes and other school events are mapped out across the year providing lots of opportunities for parents to engage in their children's learning.

SLT have strong knowledge and experience of the EYFS and provision for children from birth to also support transition into school. The EYFS Lead and reception team is also experienced in this area. Tapestry is used to assess learning and development in EYFS which is constantly sampled and monitored. Feedback is then given to all EYFS staff including LSAs to support the accurate and effective assessment of children. Previously, articles and reading has been shared with staff about assessment and staff teams asked to reflect on and discuss specific points.

CPD opportunities to develop staff's understanding of the EYFS and characteristics of effective learning are maximised either through face to face CPD or reading and activities provided. Links with LP nursery ensures that adults have a good

understanding of development and can see where children have started.

Initial inset at the start of the year gave training on wellbeing, curriculum updates and SEND/behaviour as well as Safeguarding. Weekly CPD in staff meetings for class teachers is in line with school Mission, Vision and Aims and responsive to teacher and school needs. Subject leads deliver sessions and EYFS training for teachers is planned for January 2024. Teachers and LSAs in Reception are encouraged to undertake their own CPD to keep up to date with latest developments, this has included specialist EY maths training and Talk4Writing which is a whole school approach. The school uses RWI and all EY staff are trained in this to support the early reading of our youngest pupils. Regular support from the phonics lead, online materials and training resources and development days with a consultant further support the development of practice. The EY lead attends maths consortiums and EY assessment and moderation events were attended during 2022/23. The moderation activities ensured that teachers had a good understanding of expectations so that they could focus their teaching and ensure success. GLD 2023 was 73% which is slightly above National 2022 (2023 data not yet available)

Baseline assessments are used on entry which then form the basis of target setting for individual children providing realistic but ambitious targets to ensure that children are given the best possible start to their school education. School assessments, Wellcomm and Boxall are used in addition to the DfE reception Baseline. Pupil Progress meetings to discuss individual children are held termly with SLT and key aspects for development and focus in English and Maths are discussed. Staff are supported to reflect on practice with a strong focus on children's outcomes. Teachers identify the lowest 20% of the class, key marginal children and those who are demonstrating signs of exceeding ELGS. Throughout the year, the team are supported to closely monitor progress and target specific areas of development. This results in children making significant progress and consistently exceeding National GLD data despite low starting points and high levels of SEND within cohorts.

Teachers know who their SEND and EAL groups are and understand their individual needs. Discussions with SLT and the pastoral team ensure regular monitoring of groups and how they are accessing provision. With a significant increase of children with SEND joining reception in recent year, staff liaise and work closely together to meet the needs of the individual and the cohort.

Children with SEND are identified and a SEND review took place with the SENDCO in the first Half term. Needs are monitored and parents involved when necessary. Ambitions for children remain high and levels of support needed to help each child fulfil their potential are in place.

Pupil Progress meetings allow for the discussions regarding particular groups or individual children. Discussion around SEND and EAL have including determining their individual starting points and then strategies for progress and attainment put in place. SRB support for children with Autism and other needs is also in place.

Weekly planning meets all areas of the curriculum. Key learning objectives are identified and Key workers have specific tasks to do with the children which are well planned. Curriculum topics are planned for the year but children's interests feed into the planning of activities and learning opportunities. Children have a wide range of experiences throughout the week in both indoors and outdoor areas. Evidence of this is recorded on Tapestry.

Children have plenty of opportunities for child-initiated learning which helps children to stay motivated. During and formal whole class teaching time, the children are supported by LSAs and the teaching input is short and relevant for learning. Stories, rhymes and songs are used daily to develop children's communication, listening, speech and language development and also their wider understanding of the world, communities, values and events through both fiction and non-fiction texts. Focus small group activities with adults help to ensure that children understand expectations and keeps children interested this also supports the introduction of key vocabulary. Individual needs are known by staff so that they can support children as required and measures are in place for children with additional needs.

Learning opportunities are appropriately planned to ensure there is sufficient challenge yet not so simple that children become disengaged. Challenges and focus jobs given to children help them to approach opportunities with a positive growth mindset and to build resilience and perseverance. Children have positive relationships with adults who get to know their children very well.

Our new Reception building was opened in February 2023. The impact of capital project including a reduction of play spaces, building noise outside of the classroom and packing and preparing for a move was mitigated through the opportunity to discuss growth and developments, learning about construction, involving the children in the 'adventure.' 2023/24 will be the first full year in the new classrooms. Aspects of this are still being developed, for example maximising opportunities in the outdoor area. This will continue to evolve throughout the year.

Classrooms are spacious and allow for movement between areas. Classrooms have a lockable cupboard within which they store items including cleaning materials. The outdoor space is also spacious and allows for exploration.

Children are taught about taking risks and assessing the safety of themselves and others. When risk is not appropriate, children are spoken to about this so that they understand the dangers which helps them to assess risk themselves in the future. Children are taught to be careful and safe rather than preventing any risk taking. For example in forest school. Personal safety and safeguarding are taught through the PSED curriculum including PANTS lessons, road safety, stranger danger, online safety etc.

Classrooms have risk assessment folders to monitor and analyse incidents and accidents. Staff have access to asthma inhalers, other medicines are stored out of the classroom. Allergies and dietary needs are known, this information is shared on application and also within the 'All about me' page on Tapestry. Allergies are displayed so that all staff are aware. Dietary needs are shared with the kitchen and classroom staff.

Children have settled well and have strong relationships with adults and peers. they know the routines and expectations in school due to successful transition.

Transition activities include:

- Information evening
- Nursery visits
- Home visits
- Teddy Bears Picnic event
- Additional opportunities for the children and parents to visit where SEND needs have been identified.

The first week of school is part time provision in smaller groups to support early attachments with adults and help children to learn the routines and expectations. Teachers are also able to start undertaking baselines and spend quality time with the children. Teachers and SLT contributed to this including Teachers who would cover PPA. Parents completed All about me pages which were used to plan provision before the children started including arranging meetings regarding specific needs.

Teachers meet with the SENDCO early in the year to raise concerns about specific children as required. Strategies are discussed and plans in place to support with evidence gathering for EHCP applications and/or SRB referrals. Pupil progress meetings allow for individual needs to be discussed and a review of practice to support key areas. As the year continues, pupil progress meetings become more specific regarding individual pupils and areas of

Parent engagement as a result of the transition work is strong. Sharing information continues well to keep parents informed about their children. All observations are uploaded to Tapestry and are available for parents who can also contribute. Suggestions of activities etc that can be done at home are given through Tapestry activities or shared video instruction. Parent hub is used for more generic messages to parents and a weekly newsletter is shared via ParentHub and on the website.

Information regarding the EYFS intent, implementation and impact are online along with curriculum information. Year group newsletters are shared half termly and the year group website is updated regularly. It showcases the wide range of opportunities that children have and gives curriculum and timetable information.

Parents Evening in the Autumn and Spring offer opportunities to share information about how the children had settled into school. A full written report is provided at the end of the academic Year. In addition to these, parents are invited into school for various events throughout the year including parent cafes and assemblies or whole school events.

Strengths

- The EYFS curriculum provides no limits or barriers to the children's achievements, regardless of their backgrounds, circumstances or needs. The high ambition it embodies is shared by all staff.
- The impact of the curriculum on what children know, can remember and do is strong. Children demonstrate this through being deeply engaged and sustaining high levels of concentration. Children, including those from disadvantaged backgrounds, do well. Children with SEND achieve the best possible outcomes.
- Children are highly motivated and are eager to join in. They share and cooperate well, demonstrating high levels of self-control and respect for others. Children consistently keep on trying hard, particularly if they encounter difficulties.

Opportunities for development

- Broaden opportunities for collaboration with the wider community including other schools

Overall

JUDGEMENT



School life at Drake is exceptional. Through our school values we nurture, guide, support and inspire our pupils to develop their own personalities and interests with high ambition and aspirations for their futures. Our school team are focused on the best outcomes for children and where areas for improvement are seen, actively seek to resolve this. Our child-centred approach ensures that positive relationships form the basis of all other success. Our children behave well because they want to, they are motivated to do well and to support others. Where some children have difficulties, these are understood by others and we are proud of the inclusive nature of our school despite the challenges that this may bring. We believe that every child in school, must be valued and must meet their potential. Intensive work with families and external professionals ensures that this remains a priority. Effective systems are in place and support staff well.

Leaders in school are not only mindful of the growth and development of our pupils but also the staff. Staff are valued and as a result, they too flourish which only further enhances the opportunities and experiences of our pupils. Leaders are unrelenting in the ambition for the school community and this drive ensures that we are always striving to develop, improve and excel. Our commitment to the wide opportunities for children including trips and visits, after school activities, themed events and activities, competitive events, performances and arts opportunities, collaboration and projects with other schools, a school radio, music, swimming and forest school for every child ensures that all of our children are able to discover and develop their interests and passions. Our engagement with external sources such as the John Innes Centre, Skills escalator days, Manufacturing Days help to prepare our children for their futures. Our current engagement in projects including careers related learning, Lyfta, Global Neighbours, Leading Equality and Inclusion, Courageous Advocacy will provide opportunities for the children to learn about the wider world. Whilst these are new to the school, they will feed into curriculum development over the coming years. Leaders of all levels are supported to carry out their role, senior leaders have supervision with the Executive Head of school and Middle leaders are supported by the Senior Leadership Team. Subject leads have time allocated to their role weekly or biweekly.

The curriculum design is ambitious and provides opportunities for deep learning and connections across subjects. To date, focus as part of the Covid recovery curriculum was re-establishing a curriculum maintaining the breadth without narrowing to core subjects but still being mindful of what skills and knowledge were essential to children's success. 2021/22 saw the introduction of a new curriculum and this was refined for 2022/23. We are now in the second year of delivering the new curriculum so teaching and learning is starting to include more connections between aspects of our learning and make connections to wider aspects of life and experiences. Our engagement with external advisors ensures that we access current research and subject related pedagogy. For example, we have this year engaged with the Thetford Heritage Projects and each year group will complete a project that will be supported by historians.

Children in the Early Years consistently achieve well, despite low starting points and results in GLD and phonics are consistently above national expectations. Routines and structures in place support the effective delivery of a well constructed curriculum. Children are engaged and motivated and keen to share their new learning. Our play based curriculum in Year 1 ensures that children continue to have opportunities to practice and apply learning through continuous provision and challenges suitable to their age and stage of development and this prepares the children well for the next stage of their education. Our current school key priority is to make better use of assessment systems and data to ensure that knowledge gaps are identified quickly and that this informs planning to ensure that children make progress and achieve. our developments in teaching and learning have seen a significant shift in teacher confidence and skills and as a result, outcomes for children are improving. The skilled leadership team continues to ensure that high expectations and ambitions for the children drive the pursuit of excellence and outstanding quality of education for children.